

FACT

1. Passage anchor

> “What stood out to me was that she was not the kind of person who just threw **facts** at people.”

Passage meaning

fact = a piece of information that is true and can be known or verified

事實；事實資訊；真實資料

Here, the speaker means Ms. Lau did not simply bombard students with isolated pieces of information.

So:

> **throw facts at people**

= **一味把大量事實 / 知識硬塞給別人**

The phrase is figurative and slightly critical.

Practice

1. Good teaching is not just about giving students **facts**.

好的教學不只是把**事實資料**告訴學生。

2. She helped us understand the ideas behind the **facts**.

她幫助我們理解這些**事實背後的概念**。

Core meanings of FACT

2. fact — something that is true

= something that has actually happened, exists, or can be shown to be true

事實；真相

Examples

1. It is a **fact** that water freezes at 0°C under standard conditions.

水在標準條件下攝氏零度結冰是一個**事實**。

2. We need to separate **fact** from opinion.

我們需要把**事實**和意見區分開來。

This is the central meaning.

3. a fact

= one particular true piece of information

一項事實；一個事實

Examples

1. Let me give you an important **fact**.
讓我告訴你一項重要的**事實**。
2. That **fact** changed how I understood the problem.
那項**事實**改變了我對問題的理解。

4. facts — pieces of true information

= true pieces of information, especially details that can be checked

事實；資料；真實資訊

This is the exact passage form.

Examples

1. Students need to learn both **facts** and concepts.
學生既需要學習**事實資料**，也需要理解概念。
2. The report contains useful **facts** about the issue.
這份報告包含很多關於這個問題的有用**事實資料**。

Verified information

5. fact — verified or established information

= information accepted as true because it can be supported by evidence

已證實的事實；確定資料

Examples

1. We should check the **facts** before making a claim.

我們在提出說法前應先核實**事實**。

2. The journalist confirmed the **facts**.

記者確認了相關**事實**。

6. factual information

= information based on facts rather than opinion or imagination

事實性資訊；客觀資料

Examples

1. The article provides mostly **factual information**.

這篇文章主要提供**事實性資訊**。

2. Students should distinguish **factual information** from personal opinion.

學生應區分**事實性資訊**和個人意見。

Reality rather than appearance

7. in fact

= used to introduce the truth, especially when it corrects, strengthens, or contrasts with what was said before

其實；事實上；實際上

Examples

1. I thought the test would be easy. **In fact**, it was quite difficult.

我原本以為考試會很容易。**其實**，它相當難。

2. She did not just teach physics. **In fact**, she changed the way I thought.

她不只是教物理。**事實上**，她改變了我的思考方式。

This expression appears directly in the passage later:

> **"In fact**, she did not just teach me physics..."

8. as a matter of fact

= used to state what is actually true, often with emphasis

****事實上；其實****

Examples

1. "Do you know her?" **"**As a matter of fact****, I do."
「你認識她嗎？」「****事實上****，我認識。」

2. ****As a matter of fact****, we met years ago.
****其實****，我們很多年前就見過了。

Slightly more conversational or emphatic than ****in fact**** in many contexts.

Emphasis on an undeniable reality

9. the fact is that...

= used to introduce what the speaker regards as the important reality

****事實是.....；實際情況是.....****

Examples

1. ****The fact is that**** we need more time.
****事實是****我們需要更多時間。

2. ****The fact is that**** many students find the topic difficult.
****實際情況是****很多學生覺得這個主題很難。

10. the fact that...

= the reality or truth that a particular situation exists

****.....這個事實****

Examples

1. ****The fact that she stayed calm**** helped everyone else relax.
****她保持冷靜這件事實****讓其他人也放鬆下來。

2. We cannot ignore ****the fact that the results changed****.
我們不能忽視****結果已改變這個事實****。

Very high-value grammar pattern.

Actual event / circumstance

11. fact — actual event or circumstance

= something that really happened or really exists

****實際情況；事實****

Examples

1. The decision was based on the ****facts of the case****.

這項決定是根據案件的****實際事實****作出的。

2. We need to understand the ****facts surrounding the incident****.

我們需要了解事件相關的****實際情況****。

Law

12. fact — factual issue in law

In legal contexts:

= an actual event, circumstance, or piece of evidence to be determined

****事實；案情事實****

Examples

1. The court must determine the ****facts****.

法院必須判定案件的****事實****。

2. The dispute concerns a question of ****fact****.

這項爭議涉及一個****事實問題****。

Established specialist sense.

13. question of fact

= issue about what actually happened or exists

****事實問題****

Examples

1. Whether he was present is a ****question of fact****.
他當時是否在場是一個****事實問題****。
2. The jury decides many questions of ****fact****.
陪審團會判定許多****事實問題****。

Fact contrasted with interpretation

14. fact vs opinion

****fact****

= something verifiably true

****事實****

****opinion****

= personal judgment, belief, or view

****意見；看法****

Examples

1. "The class has thirty students" is a ****fact****.
「這個班有三十名學生」是一項****事實****。
2. "This is the best class" is an ****opinion****.
「這是最好的班」是一個****意見****。

15. fact vs belief

****belief****

= something someone accepts as true

****信念；相信的事情****

A belief may or may not be a fact.

Examples

1. His ****belief**** was sincere, but it was not supported by the ****facts****.
他的****信念****很真誠，但並沒有****事實****支持。

2. We should distinguish belief from **fact**.

我們應該區分信念與**事實**。

Fixed expressions

16. the facts

= all the relevant true information about a situation

全部事實；實情

Examples

1. We do not yet know all the **facts**.

我們還不知道全部**事實**。

2. Let's look at the **facts** before deciding.

我們在決定之前先看看**實情**。

17. get the facts

= obtain accurate information

弄清事實；取得準確資料

Examples

1. We need to **get the facts** first.

我們需要先**弄清事實**。

2. The reporter spent days trying to **get the facts**.

記者花了好幾天試圖**查清事實**。

18. know for a fact

= know something with certainty

確定知道；確知

Examples

1. I **know for a fact** that she was there.

我**確定知道**她當時在那裡。

2. Do you **know for a fact** that this is true?

你**確定知道**這是真的嗎？

Strong expression of certainty.

19. face the facts

= accept an unpleasant or difficult reality

面對現實；接受事實

Examples

1. We need to **face the facts**.

我們需要**面對現實**。

2. He finally **faced the fact** that the plan had failed.

他終於**接受計畫失敗這個事實**。

20. the fact remains

= despite other information or arguments, something is still true

事實仍然是；無論如何仍有這個事實

Examples

1. The **fact remains** that we are behind schedule.

事實仍然是我們的進度落後。

2. Whatever the reason, the **fact remains** that the mistake happened.

不管原因是甚麼，**事實仍然是**錯誤已經發生。

21. despite the fact that...

= although something is true

儘管.....這個事實；雖然.....

Examples

1. She remained calm **despite the fact that she was under pressure**.

儘管她承受著壓力，她仍保持冷靜。

2. He continued **despite the fact that the task was difficult**.

雖然任務很困難，他仍繼續下去。

22. due to the fact that...

= because

由於.....；因為.....

Examples

1. The event was delayed **due to the fact that the equipment had failed**.

活動因設備故障而延遲。

2. In most ordinary writing, **because** is more concise.

在一般寫作中，使用 **because** 通常更簡潔。

The phrase is grammatically valid but often unnecessarily wordy.

"Fact" meaning established reality

23. fact of life

= unpleasant or unavoidable reality that must be accepted

生活中的現實；無可避免的事實

Examples

1. Stress is sometimes a **fact of life**.

壓力有時是生活中**無可避免的現實**。

2. Change is a **fact of life**.

改變是生活中的**必然現實**。

24. facts of life

Can mean:

A. basic realities of life

****人生現實****

B. traditionally, basic information about sex and reproduction

****性與生育的基本知識****

Examples

1. Children gradually learn the ****facts of life****.
孩子會逐漸了解一些****人生與生育的基本知識****。
2. The phrase depends heavily on context.
這個片語的意思非常依賴語境。

Related forms

25. factual

= based on, containing, or concerned with facts

****事實的；事實性的；符合事實的****

Examples

1. The report contains several ****factual errors****.
這份報告有幾個****事實錯誤****。
2. Please keep the description ****factual****.
請讓描述保持****基於事實****。

26. factually

= in terms of facts; according to what is actually true

****就事實而言；事實上；在事實層面****

Examples

1. The statement is ****factually incorrect****.
這個說法在****事實上是不正確的****。
2. The article is mostly ****factually accurate****.

這篇文章在**事實層面大致準確**。

27. fact-check

= verify whether statements or claims are accurate

****查核事實；事實核查****

Examples

1. Journalists should ****fact-check**** important claims.
記者應該對重要說法進行****事實查核****。
2. Always ****fact-check**** information before sharing it.
分享資訊前應先****查核事實****。

28. fact-checking

= process of verifying factual claims

****事實查核****

Examples

1. Good journalism requires careful ****fact-checking****.
良好的新聞工作需要仔細的****事實查核****。
2. The article failed basic ****fact-checking****.
這篇文章連基本的****事實查核****都沒有做好。

Countability

29. fact can be countable or used more generally

Countable

> a fact

> several facts

= individual true pieces of information

General / abstract

> fact rather than fiction

> fact and opinion

= truth/reality as a category

Examples

1. She gave us three important **facts**.

她告訴我們三項重要**事實**。

2. The exercise asks students to distinguish **fact from opinion**.

這項練習要求學生區分**事實與意見**。

High-value collocations

30. basic fact

= simple or fundamental piece of true information

基本事實

Examples

1. Students need to know the **basic facts** first.

學生首先需要知道一些**基本事實**。

2. These are the **basic facts** of the case.

這些是案件的**基本事實**。

31. established fact

= something firmly accepted as true on the basis of evidence

已確立的事實；公認事實

Examples

1. It is an **established fact** that regular practice improves performance.

規律練習能提升表現是一項**已確立的事實**。

2. The claim should not be treated as an **established fact** without evidence.

沒有證據時，不應把這項說法當作**已確立的事實**。

32. scientific fact

= fact supported by scientific evidence

****科學事實****

Examples

1. The lesson introduced several basic ****scientific facts****.

這堂課介紹了幾個基本的****科學事實****。

2. A scientific theory and a ****scientific fact**** are not simply the same thing.

科學理論和****科學事實****並不只是同一回事。

Key contrasts

33. fact vs information

****information****

= facts, details, data, or knowledge communicated or received

****資訊****

****fact****

= a particular thing that is actually true

****事實****

Compare:

> The website gives useful ****information****.

> 網站提供有用資訊。

> One ****fact**** is that the course lasts twelve weeks.

> 其中一項事實是課程為期十二週。

Not all information is necessarily established fact.

34. fact vs data

****data****

= recorded measurements, observations, or information used for analysis

****資料；數據****

****fact****

= something established as true

****事實****

Data may provide evidence for a fact, but they are not identical.

35. fact vs truth

****fact****

= specific verifiable reality or piece of information

****事實****

****truth****

= broader concept of what is true or corresponds to reality

****真相 ; 真理****

Compare:

> We need to check the ****facts****.

> 我們需要核實事實。

> She wanted to know the ****truth****.

> 她想知道真相。

36. fact vs evidence

****evidence****

= information or material used to support or prove a claim

****證據****

****fact****

= what is actually true

Compare:

> The fingerprints are ****evidence****.

> 指紋是證據。

> The ****fact**** is that someone entered the room.

> 事實是有人進入了房間。

37. fact vs opinion

fact

= can be checked as true or false

opinion

= personal judgment or view

This is one of the most important distinctions for learners.

38. fact vs theory

In everyday speech, **theory** can mean an explanation or idea.

In science, a **scientific theory** is a well-supported explanatory framework.

A **fact** is an observation or proposition accepted as true.

So:

theory ≠ mere guess, and

fact ≠ theory.

Meaning map

The central concept of **fact** is:

something regarded as actually true

From this develop:

Individual truth

a fact

→ **一項事實**

Multiple information units

facts

→ **事實資料**

Reality

the fact is...

→ **事實是.....**

Discourse correction

in fact

→ **其實 / 事實上**

Certainty

know for a fact

→ **確定知道**

Acceptance

face the facts

→ **面對現實**

Law

question of fact

→ **事實問題**

Family

factual

→ **事實性的**

fact-check

→ **事實查核**

The passage uses:

****facts = individual pieces of true information****

but the metaphor *****“throw facts at people”***** emphasizes that merely supplying information is not the same as helping someone understand.

MCQ-ready master list

| Form / sense

| MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |

----- -----		
fact — something true	實際存在、已發生或可以被證實為真的事情；事實	
a fact	一項具體、可確認為真的資訊	
facts — pieces of information	多項真實、可核實的資訊 / 事實資料	
fact — verified information	經證據或查證確認的事實	
factual information	以可核實事實為基礎的資訊	
in fact	用來補充、強調或修正前文所說內容；其實 / 事實上	
as a matter of fact	強調實際情況或真相；事實上 / 其實	
the fact is that...	引出最重要的實際情況；事實是.....	
the fact that...	指某件事確實存在或發生這一事實	
facts of a case/situation	某事件中實際發生、存在的相關情況	
question of fact	關於實際發生甚麼 / 甚麼是真實的事實問題	
the facts	某件事情所有重要而真實的資料 / 實情	
get the facts	查清或取得準確的事實資料	
know for a fact	對某件事有確切把握；確定知道	
face the facts	接受不一定令人愉快但真實存在的現實	
the fact remains	即使有其他因素，某件事仍然是真實的	
despite the fact that...	儘管某件事確實如此	
fact of life	必須接受、往往無法避免的生活現實	
factual	基於事實、包含事實或符合事實的	
factually	就實際事實而言；在事實層面	
fact-check	核實某項說法中的事實是否準確	
fact-checking	查證事實真偽與準確性的過程	

Passage recap

> “...she was not the kind of person who just threw ****facts**** at people.”

Here:

****facts**** = ****individual pieces of true information or knowledge****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****事實****

* ****事實資料****

* contextually: ****一堆知識 / 事實資訊****

Natural contextual translation:

****她不是那種只會把一堆事實和知識硬塞給別的人的人。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****fact**** in the passage

= ****a piece of information that is true and can be verified****

****事實；真實資訊；事實資料****

The important contrast in the passage is:

> ****give facts****

> → 告訴學生資訊

versus

> ****help students connect the dots****

> → 幫助學生理解資訊之間的關係

So Ms. Lau's strength is not merely ****knowing facts****, but turning those facts into ****understanding****.